Cairo sultanate. In order to make the *hajj*, the sacred pilgrimage to Mecca, most of the Muslim world would have to pass through Baibars's land; now that land would be friendly. At once, Baibars adopted a new title: *khadim al-haramayn al-sharifayn*, "Servant of the Two Holy Places," protector of both Mecca and Medina. In the next years, he paid for the renovation of the mosque in Medina that bore Muhammad's name, and supervised the renewed observation of Islamic laws in the sultanate (including the ban on drinking alcohol).[16]

He also renewed the war against the Crusader kingdoms, now reduced to two: the Kingdom of Jerusalem at Acre, still clinging desperately to the Mediterranean coastline; and the Principality of Antioch, which since 1201 had also encompassed Tripoli. Bypassing Acre, Baibars marched north towards Antioch and laid siege to the city itself. Antioch fell after a mere four days. Seventeen thousand of its people were taken captive, over a hundred thousand sold into the slave markets; Bohemund VI, the prince of Antioch, was left with only Tripoli.[17]

Bohemund had not been in Antioch during the siege, but Baibars thoughtfully sent him a letter describing the conquest. "Your houses [were] stormed by pillagers and ransacked by looters," he wrote,

> your women sold four at a time . . . the crosses in your churches smashed, the pages of the false Testaments scattered, the Patriarch's tombs overturned . . . your Muslim enemy trampling on the place where you celebrate the mass, cutting the throats of monks, priests, and deacons upon the altars. . . . The God who gave you Antioch has taken it away again; the Lord who bestowed that fortress on you has snatched it away, uprooting it from the face of the earth.[18]

Now only Tripoli and Acre remained in Crusader hands: Tripoli as the last remnant of the Principality of Antioch, minus Antioch; Acre, as the capital of the Kingdom of Jerusalem, which no longer controlled Jerusalem. Baibars had restored the Muslim supremacy east of the Mediterranean, a dominance that would endure for generations. "Thus, one intake comes after another and generation follows generation," Ibn Khaldun explains, "and Islam rejoices in the benefit which it gains through them, and the branches of the kingdom flourish with the freshness of youth."[19]